

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Ratnakar Naik

Address: 1 Penshurst Way Sutton SM2 6HR

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment:1. Severe existing traffic congestion

The site is next to a large school; surrounding roads (Avenue Road, Holland Avenue, Dorset Road, York Road) already experience heavy congestion during morning drop-off and afternoon pick-up times.

At peak periods, S4 and S2 buses can take more than 10 minutes to pass through the area.

Elderly passengers are particularly affected as buses struggle to access safe kerb space for boarding and alighting.

2. Overspill parking during Friday prayers

Applicant's Transport Statement identifies the Friday prayer as the busiest period.

Worst-case scenario: up to 80 vehicles, only 14 on-site spaces (11 for attendees), potentially 69 vehicles parking on residential streets.

Likely consequences include obstruction, unsafe manoeuvres, blocked driveways, pavement parking, reduced visibility, and harm to residents' quality of life.

3. Impact on elderly and mobility-impaired residents

Overspill parking and drop-off activity can force pedestrians into the carriageway and block pavements.

Elderly residents, wheelchair users, and those with mobility issues face serious safety risks.

Risks are heightened due to school traffic and narrow, constrained streets.

4. Incompatibility with residential character

The site lies wholly within a residential area, confirmed by the Council as "predominantly residential."

A large, high-capacity community hub and place of worship would be out of character with the scale, appearance, and quiet nature of the neighbourhood.

This conflicts with Sutton Local Plan Policies 28 (Character and Design) and 29 (Protecting Amenity).

5. Noise and disturbance

Dispersal of up to 250 people at around 11pm would significantly increase vehicle movements near residents' gardens.

Such activity would materially harm residential amenity.

6. Poor public transport accessibility

PTAL rating of 1a indicates the site is unsuitable for high-traffic use.

Council highlights increased on-street parking pressure and highway safety risks, especially during peak Friday events.

This conflicts with Sutton Local Plan Policies 36 and 37.

7. Visual impact

Proposed building would appear incongruous in the streetscape.

Fails to integrate with the established domestic character of surrounding properties (Policy 28).

8. No demonstrated local need

Applicant already has access to a large venue with extensive parking less than one mile away.

Multiple mosques and community facilities operate within 1-1.5 miles of Belmont.

Introducing another intensive use in a quiet residential area is unnecessary and unjustified.

Conclusion

For these reasons, the proposal would harm residential amenity, road safety, and the character of the area.

Strong objection is submitted, and the Council is urged to refuse any future application.